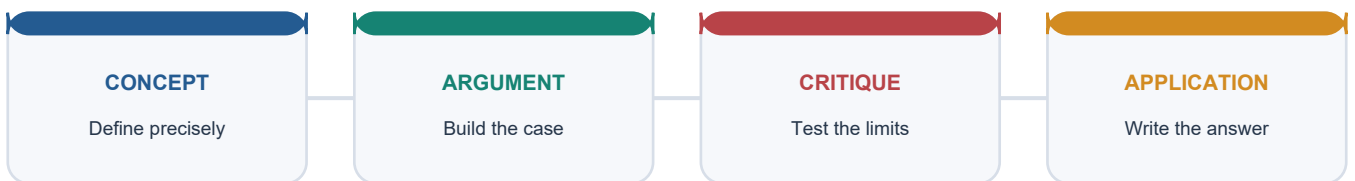


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Political Ideologies - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Political Ideologies - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone workbook. It reproduces the complete practice apparatus of the Political Ideologies learning package and can be worked without the teaching sessions. Syllabus, verbatim: *Political Ideologies: Anarchism; Marxism and Socialism*. - UPSC Philosophy Paper II, Section A, item 5. Three families are printed and only three; Godwin, Proudhon, Bakunin, Kropotkin and Tolstoy appear because the anarchist taxonomy is theirs, Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Miliband and Poulantzas because owned previous-year parts on Marxism's relevance, on ideology and on the state require them, Owen, Fourier and Saint-Simon because "utopian" is defined against them, and Gandhi and M. N. Roy because two owned parts name Gandhi directly and Roy is the internal Indian criticism of party absolutism. **Liberalism and neoliberalism are comparison foils only, and fascism is neither printed nor routed by any 2018-2025 part.** Political obligation and the civil-disobedience ladder belong to **Individual and State**; Marxian equity against equality as the demanded concept to **Social and Political Ideals**; development programmes and progress metrics to **Development and Social Progress**; Gandhi-Ambedkar caste theory to **Caste Discrimination**; Weber, Schumpeter, Michels and populism to **Forms of Government**; recognition against redistribution to **Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism**; and Marxist and socialist feminism to **Gender Discrimination** - all routed rather than developed.

Evidence discipline: FACT: doctrine on which the standard sources converge · ANALYSIS: analytical reconstruction for exam use · CAUTION: a live scholarly dispute. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper II.

Terminology and citation rule: the English concept leads and the technical term follows immediately in parentheses - a connected, action-guiding structure of description, diagnosis, evaluation, prescription and end-state (a political ideology), a framework in which historically specific relations appear natural, universal or inevitable (ideology in the critical Marxist sense), the absence or collapse of effective rule (anarchy), the normative critique of coercive authority with a programme of voluntary order (anarchism), the denial of any automatic duty to obey the state (philosophical anarchism), possession and reciprocal exchange without exploitative property relations (mutualism), cooperation as a genuine source of social order (mutual aid), labour-power, knowledge, tools and technology (productive forces), ownership, control and class relations (relations of production), the unity of forces and relations (mode of production), estrangement from product, activity, species-being and other persons (alienation), conscious, creative and social activity as the distinctively human capacity (species-being), value produced beyond the value represented by wages and appropriated by capital (surplus value), appropriation rooted in the relation of production rather than in intention (structural exploitation), the transitional political supremacy of the working class (dictatorship of the proletariat), the projected classless order in which the political state as an instrument of class domination is unnecessary (communism), revolution breaking where capitalism's global chain is most vulnerable (the weakest link), free discussion before decision and unity of action after it (democratic centralism), the party standing for the class, then the committee for the party (substitutionism), cultural and intellectual leadership securing consent (hegemony), the sphere of force and law (political society), the sphere of consent - school, family, church, press, association (civil society), the patient construction of a counter-hegemony (war of position), apparatuses functioning primarily by violence (Repressive State Apparatus), apparatuses functioning primarily by ideology (Ideological State Apparatuses), the hailing that constitutes a subject who freely performs what the structure requires (interpellation), the state as an instrument held by a class (instrumentalism), the state's real but bounded independence from any fraction of capital (relative autonomy), the state as an arena compressing class forces (condensation of class forces), the subjection of productive property to social control (socialism), transfer of ownership to the organs of the state (nationalisation), effective control by society through democratic institutions (socialisation), property held as a social obligation administered for the community (trusteeship), self-rule beginning in mastery of desire and local self-government (swarāj), and the welfare of all, including the last (sarvodaya). Provenance is examinable: **Marx, Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts, 1844; Marx and Engels, Manifesto of the Communist Party, 1848; Marx, Preface to A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy, 1859; Marx, Critique of the Gotha Programme, 1875; Miliband, The State in Capitalist Society, 1969; Poulantzas, Political Power and Social Classes, 1973; the Constitution of India, Part IV, Articles 38, 39 and 43**, which are non-justiciable. No page, chapter, edition or invented quotation is attached to any author, and **no date is asserted** for Godwin, Proudhon, Bakunin, Kropotkin, Tolstoy, Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Engels, Owen, Fourier, Saint-Simon, Gandhi or Roy. **WRONG:** No Indian party, government, leader or period is characterised, and no statute, scheme or judgment is used as evidence for or against a philosophical thesis.

What this workbook contains

Component	Count
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	13
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6

How to use it

1. Attempt the twenty-four core MCQs without notes, then read every option explanation, including those for the options you rejected. The key sequence is **unpatterned** - each answer was fixed independently - so no cycle can be guessed, and option lengths are matched so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape.
2. Work the eight remedial drills only after the core set. They target socialism collapsed into communism, "utopian" read as an insult and "scientific" as a guarantee, Gandhian trusteeship presented without its objection, fascism or liberalism imported as printed families and the 2022 equity part wrongly claimed, invented dates for authors the repository does not date, an Indian statute used as philosophical proof, the anarchist-Marxist exchange declared settled, and relevance stems answered with examples instead of the three-column judgment.
3. Attempt each previous-year part under time before reading its solution. **Decide the family from the stem first:** four owned parts concern anarchism, two concern Gandhi, six concern Marxism, and two concern socialism as a family - one of which is shared with Gandhi.
4. Write the six original models in full. Two are 10-mark, two 15-mark and two 20-mark, and each sits inside the declared word band - **10 marks about 150 to 220 words, 15 marks about 250 to 330, 20 marks about 330 to 400.**
5. Check every answer against the traps: anarchy used for anarchism, anarchism defined only negatively, Proudhon quoted without the qualification, Godwin and Tolstoy omitted from a taxonomy, "thesis-antithesis-synthesis" attributed to Marx, base -> superstructure written as a mechanical cause, alienation treated as unhappiness or merged with exploitation, "dictatorship of the proletariat" read in its twentieth-century sense, "to each according to contribution" presented as Marx's ideal, the qualifier dropped from "relative autonomy", Gramsci merged with Althusser, socialism identified with state ownership, socialism used as a synonym for communism, and any Indian actor characterised.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated and no cycle such as ABCD - or its reverse - can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Political Ideologies: Anarchism; Marxism and Socialism* - together with the six-component test for an ideology and the discriminating question of domination, the two senses of "ideology", anarchy against anarchism and the minimal-state test, the burden-of-justification argument and its load-bearing premise, Proudhon's qualification on property, the five strands and the Godwin-Tolstoy lineage, the four objections and the one that is conceded, Gandhi as a qualified political anarchist, Marxism's four simultaneous aspects and the safe use of dialectical materialism, historical materialism's fetters mechanism and the base-superstructure caution, alienation's four dimensions with the wages distinction, exploitation as structural and its difference from inequality, ideology as naturalisation rather than deception, the transitional dictatorship and communism, the Gotha two-phase distinction, the four classical claims revised by Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband-Poulantzas and Althusser, the agency difference between hegemony and the apparatuses, the internal limit of relative autonomy, and socialism as a family with the nationalisation-is-not-socialisation control. The eight remedial drills attack the errors that cost marks every year on this clause: collapsing socialism into communism, reading "utopian" as an insult and "scientific" as a guarantee, presenting Gandhian trusteeship without its objection, importing fascism or liberalism or claiming the 2022 equity part, mis-dating the provenance items the paper can punish, using an Indian statute as proof of a philosophical thesis, presenting the anarchist-Marxist exchange as settled, and answering a relevance stem with examples instead of the three-column judgment.

MCQ 1. What has to be present before a structure counts as a political ideology

A candidate defines anarchism simply as "the belief that the state should be abolished". On the six-component test used in this package, what is chiefly missing from that definition?

- A. The historical sequence through which the doctrine developed, without which no political ideology can be properly identified or compared with its rivals.
- B. The names of the principal thinkers associated with it, since an ideology is constituted by the authors who articulate and defend its positions.
- C. The description, diagnosis, evaluation, strategy and regulative picture, without which an evaluative slogan has been supplied in place of a structure.
- D. The empirical evidence for its claims about society, since a doctrine unsupported by observation cannot count as an action-guiding political structure.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: chronology helps avoid anachronism but is not one of the six components, and a structure containing all six would qualify even if its history were unknown.
- **B:** Incorrect: thinkers illustrate an ideology rather than constitute it, and the same doctrine can be held by writers who never read one another.
- **C:** Correct: an ideology requires a description of person, society and power, a diagnosis of domination, an evaluation through freedom, equality and justice, a view of property, authority and the state, a strategy of change and a regulative picture of the order sought.
- **D:** Incorrect: empirical support bears on whether an ideology is true, not on whether the structure before us is an ideology at all.

Examiner trap 1: Opening an "evaluate X as a political ideology" answer without defining what an ideology is spends the introduction on the doctrine and leaves the examiner with no sign that the candidate has noticed the word the stem actually turns on.

MCQ 2. The question that separates the three printed families

On the account developed in this package, what single question do anarchism, Marxism and socialism answer differently, and how do their answers divide?

- A. What chiefly produces domination - anarchism answers coercive authority, socialism answers socially uncontrolled property, and Marxism answers class relations generated by the mode of production.
- B. What form of government is best - anarchism answers direct democracy, socialism answers parliamentary rule, and Marxism answers the dictatorship of a disciplined vanguard party of professional revolutionaries.
- C. How wealth should be distributed - anarchism answers by need, socialism answers by contribution, and Marxism answers by an equal division of the total social product among all producing citizens.
- D. Whether human nature is good - anarchism answers yes, socialism answers conditionally, and Marxism answers that the question is settled by the level of productive forces a society has attained.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the discriminating question is what chiefly produces domination and what institutional change would remove it, and the three families are three rival answers to precisely that question.
- **B:** Incorrect: forms of government belong to a different owner, and none of the three families is defined by a preferred constitutional form.
- **C:** Incorrect: distribution is one axis among seven, and the contribution/need contrast belongs inside Marx's own two-phase account rather than between the families.
- **D:** Incorrect: anarchism is an institutional thesis rather than an optimistic anthropology, and Marxism makes no claim that productive forces settle questions of human nature.

Examiner trap 2: Treating the clause as three separate topics produces three sequential mini-essays, which is the commonest structural failure here and is visible to the examiner within the first paragraph of the answer.

MCQ 3. The two senses of "ideology" inside this clause

Why must a candidate declare which sense of "ideology" is in play before answering a stem in this clause?

- A. Because the syllabus prints the word in the title of the clause, and examiners expect the printed wording to be reproduced verbatim in the opening line of every answer.
- B. Because the analytical sense applies to anarchism and socialism while the critical sense applies only to Marxism, so the wrong sense makes two of the three families unintelligible.
- C. Because one sense is used by supporters of a doctrine and the other by its opponents, so the choice signals whether the candidate is defending or attacking the position taken.
- D. Because the analytical sense names an avowed, argued structure while the critical sense names a framework in which historically specific relations appear natural and inevitable.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: reproducing the syllabus wording is good practice but has nothing to do with the ambiguity, which is conceptual rather than presentational.
- **B:** Incorrect: the critical sense is a general account of how any social order naturalises itself, and it is not restricted in application to Marxism alone.
- **C:** Incorrect: both senses are used analytically by supporters and critics alike, and neither carries an inbuilt evaluative stance towards the doctrine described.
- **D:** Correct: the analytical sense picks out an organised, avowed and argued action-guiding structure, whereas the critical sense picks out a socially rooted framework through which historically specific relations appear natural, universal or inevitable.

Examiner trap 3: Using "ideology" as a synonym for opinion, slogan or party programme abandons the concept that makes Marxism simultaneously an ideology in one sense and the theory of ideology in the other.

MCQ 4. Anarchy against anarchism

A 2020-pattern stem asks whether a prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society. Which discrimination decides the answer?

- A. Anarchism refers to a movement while anarchy refers to a political party, so the stem is asking about organisational strength rather than about the doctrine itself.
- B. Anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule and may mean disorder, while anarchism is a normative critique of domination that proposes non-coercive order.
- C. Anarchy describes conditions in developing societies while anarchism describes conditions in developed ones, so the stem depends on which type of society is meant.
- D. Anarchy applies to short-term breakdown while anarchism applies to the same breakdown once it has persisted long enough to become the society's normal condition.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: neither term names a party, and treating the stem as a question about organisational strength substitutes a sociological enquiry for a philosophical one.
- **B:** Correct: anarchy is a condition that may mean disorder, whereas anarchism is a doctrine with a positive institutional programme of voluntary association, mutual aid and federation.
- **C:** Incorrect: the distinction is conceptual and not developmental, and neither term is indexed to a level of economic development.

- **D:** Incorrect: duration does not convert a breakdown into a doctrine, and a permanently disordered society would still be an instance of anarchy rather than of anarchism.

Examiner trap 4: Writing about looting, breakdown and the failure of authority answers a question about a condition when the paper has asked about an ideology, and no amount of subsequent argument recovers the marks lost in the framing.

MCQ 5. Why the libertarian minimal state is not a mild anarchism

What exactly does anarchism object to in the night-watchman state restricted to protecting person and property?

- A. Its excessive size, since a state confined to protection still employs large numbers of officials and consumes resources that voluntary associations could use more efficiently.
- B. Its indifference to distribution, since a state that protects property without redistributing it entrenches the inequalities that the anarchist tradition exists to attack.
- C. Its historical origins, since every existing minimal state emerged from conquest and can therefore claim no legitimacy for the functions it has retained.
- D. Its retained monopoly, since anarchism targets the exclusive standing right to make, enforce and adjudicate law rather than the number of functions performed.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: size is not the discriminating test, and a very small state that retains the monopoly remains the target of the burden-of-justification argument.
- **B:** Incorrect: distributive objections belong to the socialist and Marxist families, and several individualist anarchists share the minimal state's view of redistribution.
- **C:** Incorrect: the anarchist claim is that historical existence establishes nothing about legitimacy either way, so origins cannot do the work this option assigns them.
- **D:** Correct: anarchism rejects even the minimal state's monopoly of law-making, coercion and punishment, which is what the argument against a standing right to command is directed at.

Examiner trap 5: Presenting anarchism as "the smallest possible government" makes it a variety of libertarianism and loses the doctrine's central claim, which concerns the exclusive right to command rather than the scale of administration.

MCQ 6. The load-bearing premise of the anarchist argument

In the five-step argument against the state, which premise does the anarchist conclusion actually depend on, and why?

- A. The first, that legitimate authority must respect the autonomy and equality of persons, because this premise is denied by every serious defender of the state and is therefore where the dispute properly begins.
- B. The second, that the state claims a territorial monopoly, because a monopoly is by definition unjustifiable and the remaining premises merely elaborate that impossibility.
- C. The third, that obedience is demanded because a command is legally authoritative rather than because its content is independently right, since content-independence generates the subordination.
- D. The fifth, that the burden of justification has not been discharged, because the anarchist's whole case consists in the demonstrated historical failure of every consent theory to supply a justification.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the first premise is the least contested step in the chain, since defenders of the state typically accept it and argue that political authority satisfies it.
- **B:** Incorrect: a monopoly is not unjustifiable by definition, and the argument has to show why this particular monopoly cannot be justified rather than assuming it.

- **C:** Correct: content-independence is what distinguishes legal authority from moral advice, and it is precisely the demand for obedience irrespective of the addressee's own assessment that subordinates judgment to institutional will.
- **D:** Incorrect: the fifth step is the conclusion rather than a premise, and it records the anarchist's verdict on the preceding chain instead of supporting it.

Examiner trap 6: Writing the argument as continuous prose hides its structure; an examiner can see a numbered chain of premises immediately and cannot see an argument that has been dissolved into a paragraph of description.

MCQ 7. Proudhon on property, stated precisely

Which formulation reproduces Proudhon's attack on property without overstating it?

- A. Property is attacked where it functions as an institutional power of appropriation and dependence, which leaves possession and reciprocal exchange defensible.
- B. Property in every form is theft, so that personal possessions, tools of trade and dwellings are equally illegitimate and must be surrendered to the commune.
- C. Property is legitimate where it is acquired by labour, so that all inherited holdings are void while purchased and worked holdings remain fully justified.
- D. Property is a natural right that the state has corrupted, so that abolishing the state would restore property to its original and uncorrupted moral condition.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the target is property where it operates as a power of appropriation and dependence over others' labour and life-chances, which is exactly why mutualism can defend possession while attacking property.
- **B:** Incorrect: the blanket reading strips out the qualification that makes mutualism coherent, since mutualism explicitly preserves possession and exchange.
- **C:** Incorrect: the labour-acquisition criterion belongs to a different tradition and does not capture Proudhon's objection to property as an institutional relation of power.
- **D:** Incorrect: this reverses the position, since Proudhon treats exploitative property as itself a source of domination rather than as a natural right corrupted by government.

Examiner trap 7: Quoting the slogan without the qualification makes Proudhon appear to attack personal possessions, and it removes the distinction between possession and property on which his whole programme of contracts and workers' associations depends.

MCQ 8. Sorting the anarchist strands

Four anarchist strands divide on the property axis and a fifth does not. Which statement correctly identifies the odd one and its distinctive claim?

- A. Individualist anarchism, which is distinctive because it permits markets and therefore cannot be located on an axis concerned with the ownership of productive resources.
- B. Philosophical anarchism, which is distinctive because it asserts that there is no automatic duty to obey the state while permitting critical allegiance to existing institutions.
- C. Anarcho-communism, which is distinctive because distribution by need concerns the disposal of the product rather than the ownership of the means of producing it.
- D. Mutualism, which is distinctive because contracts and workers' associations are coordinating devices rather than positions about who owns productive resources.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: individualist anarchism does take a position on property, asserting strong personal sovereignty, and its internal disagreement about markets is a variation within that position.
- **B:** Correct: philosophical anarchism is defined by a claim about legitimacy rather than about ownership, holding that there is no automatic duty to obey while allowing critical allegiance to institutions.
- **C:** Incorrect: anarcho-communism is squarely on the property axis, since common ownership of productive resources is precisely what it asserts.
- **D:** Incorrect: mutualism's defence of possession against exploitative property is a property position, and its contractual devices follow from that position rather than replacing it.

Examiner trap 8: Presenting all anarchists as collectivists ignores individualist and market-oriented variants, and it makes the family look internally uniform when the taxonomy question is asked precisely because it is not.

MCQ 9. Godwin and Tolstoy, kept precise

Which pair of statements about Godwin and Tolstoy is accurate as the sources present them?

- A. Godwin advocates immediate insurrection against every existing government, and Tolstoy is the direct originator of Gandhi's organised mass politics and his constructive programme.
- B. Godwin offers rational and educative criticism of government as coercion recedes, and Tolstoy offers a Christian-pacifist refusal that influenced Gandhi without being identical to him.
- C. Godwin founds anarcho-communism on mutual aid, and Tolstoy founds collectivist anarchism on the claim that concentrated revolutionary authority creates a new ruling stratum.
- D. Godwin defends possession against exploitative property, and Tolstoy defends the abolition of organised religion as a precondition of any genuinely anarchist social order.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Godwin expects cooperation to grow as coercive institutions recede rather than calling for insurrection, and Gandhi's organised mass politics has no Tolstoyan counterpart.
- **B:** Correct: this reproduces both attributions with the two qualifications the paper can punish - Godwin's educative rationalism and Tolstoy's status as an influence on rather than an equivalent of Gandhi.
- **C:** Incorrect: mutual aid and anarchist communism belong to Kropotkin, and the warning about a new ruling stratum belongs to Bakunin.
- **D:** Incorrect: the defence of possession is Proudhon's, and Tolstoy's position is a Christian-pacifist refusal of violence rather than an abolition of religion.

Examiner trap 9: Omitting Godwin and Tolstoy from a strand-and-thinker taxonomy loses the breadth mark, while merging Tolstoy into Gandhi loses the precision mark - and a taxonomy stem is scored on both.

MCQ 10. Which objection to anarchism is conceded

Of the four standing objections to anarchism, which one receives a reply that is an admission rather than a refutation?

- A. The security dilemma, because the anarchist can only observe that states have themselves organised war and repression, which leaves the problem of private predation entirely unaddressed.
- B. The scale objection, because delegated and federated administration remains an aspiration for which the tradition supplies no worked institutional design at any level of complexity.
- C. The anthropological objection, because anarchists must ultimately assume a degree of natural benevolence that the historical record does not support anywhere.
- D. The hidden-authority objection, because expertise, informal status and economic power return after the state disappears and must be scrutinised inside voluntary associations.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the security reply is more than a counter-accusation, since it adds federated defence and restorative institutions as the positive institutional proposal.
- **B:** Incorrect: the scale reply relocates the dispute successfully by distinguishing centralised domination from coordination, which is a substantive answer rather than an admission.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the strongest of the four replies, because anarchists need only deny that coercive hierarchy is the unique or best remedy rather than assert benevolence.
- **D:** Correct: the reply concedes that this is a serious internal challenge and redirects anarchist theory towards scrutinising domination inside voluntary associations rather than merely abolishing formal offices.

Examiner trap 10: Answering all four objections with equal confidence conceals the asymmetry that a critical-examination stem is scored on, and it removes the residual that decides whether political authority can be dispensed with completely.

MCQ 11. Gandhi as a political anarchist

Which formulation states the relation between Gandhi and anarchism with the precision an evaluation stem requires?

- A. Gandhi is a moral and decentralist anarchist in ideal but a pragmatic reformer in political method, since non-violence, trusteeship and the constructive programme replace class war.
- B. Gandhi is a complete anarchist, since his demand for village self-rule and a minimal state is identical in content to the revolutionary programmes of Bakunin and Kropotkin alike.
- C. Gandhi is not an anarchist in any respect, since he negotiated with an imperial government and accepted an independent state possessing an army and a police force.
- D. Gandhi is an anarchist in method but not in ideal, since satyāgraha is a form of direct action while his end-state retains a fully sovereign national government.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the affinity holds at the level of the regulative ideal - self-rule, decentralised village republics, a state reduced to a minimum - while non-violence, trusteeship, religious ethics and the constructive programme break with classical social anarchism's method.
- **B:** Incorrect: the identification ignores four structural breaks, of which the replacement of expropriation by trusteeship and of anti-theism by religious ethics are the sharpest.
- **C:** Incorrect: the objection is decisive against an unqualified identification and irrelevant against the qualified claim the stem invites the candidate to assess.
- **D:** Incorrect: this inverts the relation, since it is the end-state that is anarchist and the method that is reformist rather than the other way round.

Examiner trap 11: Answering an "evaluate" stem with a flat yes or a flat no discards the qualification in which the marks lie, because the examiner is testing whether the candidate can locate exactly where a description fits and where it fails.

MCQ 12. Marxism's four simultaneous aspects

Why does the package insist that an evaluation of Marxism must separate four aspects before delivering a verdict?

- A. Because the four aspects were developed by four different thinkers in four different historical periods, so a verdict on Marxism must first specify which of the four authors is being evaluated.
- B. Because the syllabus prints Marxism alongside socialism, and the four aspects are the conventional device for distinguishing the two printed families of doctrine from one another.
- C. Because Marxism is simultaneously a method, a critique, a theory of change and a political project, and its diagnostic power and institutional record must be graded on different scales.
- D. Because a four-part structure is the conventional length for a fifteen-mark answer, and each aspect supplies roughly one paragraph of the required exposition.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: all four aspects are present in Marx himself, and the later revisions of Sessions 15 to 17 modify specific claims rather than supplying separate aspects.
- **B:** Incorrect: socialism and Marxism are distinguished by the family/member relation and by the range of methods and ownership forms, not by this fourfold division.
- **C:** Correct: the division prevents the illegitimate inference that a failure of the political project refutes the method or the critique, which is exactly what an evaluation stem tests.
- **D:** Incorrect: the division is analytical rather than presentational, and using it as a paragraph template rather than as a grading device produces four descriptions and no verdict.

Examiner trap 12: Delivering one global verdict on "Marxism" concedes that the candidate has not noticed the doctrine contains an analysis that may survive and a transitional programme that may not.

MCQ 13. Using dialectical materialism safely

Which combination correctly states what to keep from Hegel, what Marx rejects, and what should not be attributed to Marx at all?

- A. Keep the self-developing Idea, reject material conditioning, and do not attribute the claim that contradiction drives development, which belongs to Engels alone.
- B. Keep the primacy of consciousness, reject class struggle as a historical motor, and do not attribute the base-superstructure vocabulary, which is a later addition.
- C. Keep the priority of nature over history, reject praxis as a category, and do not attribute the doctrine of the withering away of the state to Marx himself.
- D. Keep the idea that contradiction drives development, reject the primacy of the self-developing Idea, and do not attribute "thesis-antithesis-synthesis" to Marx as a fixed law.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this exactly reverses the inheritance, since Marx retains the role of contradiction and rejects the Idea rather than the other way round.
- **B:** Incorrect: the primacy of consciousness is what Marx inverts, class struggle is central to his account, and base and superstructure are his own vocabulary.
- **C:** Incorrect: praxis is a Marxian category rather than one he rejects, and the expectation about the state's withering is part of the tradition he initiates.

- **D:** Correct: contradiction as the motor of development is retained, the self-developing Idea is rejected in favour of contradictions embedded in material life, and the three-step formula is a later textbook shorthand.

Examiner trap 13: Writing "thesis-antithesis-synthesis" as Marx's own formula is a small attribution error that signals a large gap, because it shows the candidate has learned a summary rather than the argument.

MCQ 14. The mechanism inside historical materialism

A 2023-pattern stem asks the candidate to explain historical materialism and discuss its relevance to social development and change. Which element supplies the mechanism of change?

- A. The base-superstructure relation, since law, politics and ideology are the instruments through which the ruling class directly imposes each successive mode of production.
- B. The development of productive forces to the point where existing relations of production become fetters, so that the conflict is fought out as social and political struggle.
- C. The distinction between productive forces and relations of production, since a classification of the two is what allows historical epochs to be distinguished from one another.
- D. The definition of the mode of production as the unity of forces and relations, since a unity of opposites is by itself sufficient to generate transformation over time.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this presents the superstructure as an instrument of imposition and omits the developmental mechanism entirely, leaving no account of why one mode gives way to another.
- **B:** Correct: the fetters step is what converts the vocabulary into an engine, identifying a mechanism by which development inside a set of ownership relations generates capacities those relations cannot accommodate.
- **C:** Incorrect: the distinction is necessary for stating the mechanism but is a classificatory device rather than the mechanism itself.
- **D:** Incorrect: naming the mode of production as a unity describes a structure at rest, and no transformation follows from the definition without the development of the forces.

Examiner trap 14: Listing the five elements without the fetters mechanism answers the exposition half of the stem and silently abandons the half that concerns development and change.

MCQ 15. The base-superstructure caution

Which criticism of historical materialism should a candidate concede, and which should be refused?

- A. Concede that Marx denied any role whatever to political agency; refuse the claim that the theory has anything of substance to say about law, religion, art or culture.
- B. Concede that the theory is a description of feudal and early capitalist Europe only; refuse the claim that it makes any prediction about the direction of historical change.
- C. Concede a tendency toward economic reductionism; refuse the claim that Marx held the economic base to cause every idea mechanically, since he allows reciprocal effects and agency.
- D. Concede that the base and the superstructure are wholly indistinguishable in practice; refuse the claim that ownership relations carry any explanatory priority whatever.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Marx allows political agency, so this concedes a claim that is false and refuses one that is central to the theory's scope.
- **B:** Incorrect: the theory is explicitly general and offers an account of transitions between modes of production, so both halves misstate it.
- **C:** Correct: the reciprocal-effects qualification is genuinely Marx's, so the crude determinism should be refused, while the tendency to give economic factors too much weight is the serious objection worth conceding first.

- **D:** Incorrect: conceding that the two are indistinguishable would abandon the theory's explanatory structure rather than defending it against an overstated charge.

Examiner trap 15: Writing base -> superstructure as a one-way mechanical cause hands the examiner the reductionism objection before it has been put, and no later qualification recovers the ground given away in that sentence.

MCQ 16. Alienation, stated as Marx states it

Which statement captures the feature of alienation that a 2024-pattern exposition stem is chiefly scored on?

- A. That alienation is broader than low wages, since a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others.
- B. That alienation is a psychological condition produced by long working hours, which is why reductions in the working day are its most direct remedy.
- C. That alienation arises only under industrial factory production, so that agricultural and artisanal labour are by their nature free from estrangement.
- D. That alienation is identical with exploitation, since both describe the appropriation of the worker's product by the owner of the means of production.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the wages distinction is the mark-bearing move, because it establishes that the concept concerns control over product, activity and purpose rather than remuneration.
- **B:** Incorrect: alienation is a structural relation and not a mood, and shorter hours leave the control of labour, product and purpose exactly where they were.
- **C:** Incorrect: the analysis concerns the relation under which labour is performed, and nothing in it confines estrangement to factory settings.
- **D:** Incorrect: exploitation concerns appropriation of what is produced while alienation concerns dispossession of the activity and its meaning, and the paper has asked about each separately.

Examiner trap 16: Treating alienation as unhappiness at work converts a philosophical category into a description of morale, and it makes the four dimensions look like a list of complaints rather than a derivation.

MCQ 17. Exploitation, and what distinguishes it from inequality

Why does Marx insist that capitalist exploitation differs from theft, and what distinction follows?

- A. Because labour-power is bought under a formally free contract, so exploitation is a property of the relation of production while inequality is a property of the distribution of holdings.
- B. Because employers pay less than the prevailing market rate for labour, so exploitation is a failure of competition while inequality is the ordinary result of differences in skill and effort.
- C. Because the state protects the property of owners against all comers, so exploitation is a legal artefact while inequality is a natural feature of any society with a division of labour.
- D. Because workers do not understand the value they actually create, so exploitation is a cognitive failure while inequality is the measurable outcome that follows directly from that failure.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the formally free contract is what makes the critique a critique of rules rather than of rule-breaking, and it generates the distinction on which redistribution may reduce inequality while leaving exploitative control intact.
- **B:** Incorrect: paying below a market rate would be a competitive imperfection, whereas Marx's claim holds even where the contract is entirely regular and the market fully competitive.
- **C:** Incorrect: legal protection of property is part of the setting rather than the mechanism, and describing exploitation as a legal artefact removes the structural compulsion of competition.

- **D:** Incorrect: exploitation is a relation and not a belief, and it would continue unchanged if every worker understood the arithmetic perfectly.

Examiner trap 17: Describing exploitation as cheating or underpayment makes enforcement of existing rules the remedy, which is precisely the conclusion the analysis was constructed to block.

MCQ 18. Ideology and the state in the classical critique

Which pair of formulations states the classical Marxist claims about ideology and the state without the crudity that invites immediate counter-example?

- A. Ideology is deliberate deception practised by the ruling class, and the state is a neutral arbiter that the wealthy occasionally succeed in capturing for their own narrowly private purposes.
- B. Ideology is the sum of a society's inherited superstitions, and the state is an autonomous bureaucracy pursuing institutional interests entirely distinct from those of every social class.
- C. Ideology is a framework in which historically specific relations appear natural, and the state secures the general conditions of the capitalist order while presenting itself as universal.
- D. Ideology is whatever a political party asserts in its published programme, and the state is the instrument that executes that programme once the party has secured an electoral majority.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: ideology is not merely a lie, and treating the state as a neutral arbiter occasionally captured is the pluralist position rather than the Marxist one.
- **B:** Incorrect: this drops the connection to specific relations of production and makes the state autonomous in the unqualified sense that Session 17 shows would end the analysis.
- **C:** Correct: both formulations are precise, and the second carries the immediate qualification that relative autonomy is compatible with structural class function.
- **D:** Incorrect: reducing ideology to a party programme abandons the critical concept entirely and reduces the state to an administrative mechanism.

Examiner trap 18: Writing the instrumentalist claim without attaching relative autonomy walks straight into the standard counter-example of regulation and welfare directed against particular capitalists.

MCQ 19. The transitional dictatorship and communism

Which statement about the dictatorship of the proletariat and communism follows the sources exactly?

- A. Communism is a form of government in which a single disciplined party exercises permanent supremacy, and the dictatorship of the proletariat is the constitutional device that establishes it.
- B. The dictatorship of the proletariat denotes a transitional political supremacy of the working class, and communism is the classless order in which the political state loses its class function.
- C. The dictatorship of the proletariat is simply a synonym for socialism in its lower phase, and communism is the moment at which productive forces are fully socialised under central planning.
- D. Communism is the abolition of all authority whatever, and the dictatorship of the proletariat is the transitional period during which the last surviving forms of coordination are dismantled.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the transitional supremacy of a class is not in itself a textual licence for permanent one-party rule, and the historical objection has to be argued rather than read off the word.
- **B:** Correct: both definitions are reproduced as the sources give them, with the transitional character of the first and the class-function language of the second preserved.
- **C:** Incorrect: this conflates a political form with a distributive phase and drops the classless, stateless content of the communist end-state.

- **D:** Incorrect: the abolition of all authority is the anarchist end-state, and Marx expects the state to lose its class function rather than coordination to disappear.

Examiner trap 19: Reading "dictatorship" in its twentieth-century sense converts a claim about class supremacy into a claim about party rule, which is exactly the equivocation the historical objection needs to be argued rather than assumed.

MCQ 20. The Gotha two-phase distinction

What does Marx's *Critique of the Gotha Programme* establish about distribution, and what must not be inferred from it?

- A. That distribution by contribution is the communist ideal, and that distribution according to need is a utopian aspiration Marx explicitly rejects as incompatible with material scarcity.
- B. That equal legal right becomes sufficient once class ownership ends, and that no further distributive principle is required in either phase of a fully communist society.
- C. That distribution should be identical for all persons from the outset, and that any differential provision reintroduces the bourgeois right the revolution was meant to abolish.
- D. That the lower phase distributes by contribution while retaining a bourgeois measure and the higher phase aspires to distribution by need, which is a projection rather than a law.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: distribution by contribution is criticised by Marx as a residue of the old order, and distribution by need belongs to the higher phase rather than being rejected.
- **B:** Incorrect: Marx's specific criticism is of equal legal right operating over radically unequal social conditions, so equal right is precisely what is found insufficient.
- **C:** Incorrect: identical provision for all is not the Marxian position, and the equity concept exists to justify differential provision by need.
- **D:** Correct: the two-phase structure is reproduced accurately, and the limitation that it is a normative projection rather than a demonstrated historical law is preserved.

Examiner trap 20: Presenting "to each according to contribution" as Marx's ideal reverses his argument, since it is the very measure he identifies as bourgeois and expects a later phase to abandon.

MCQ 21. Which classical claim each successor revises

Which mapping of classical Marxist claims to their revisers is correct as the sources present it?

- A. Lenin revises the theory of ideology, Gramsci the theory of imperialism, Althusser the theory of the state and Poulantzas the theory of consciousness.
- B. Gramsci revises the location of revolution, Lenin revises the theory of the subject, Miliband revises historical materialism and Althusser revises the vanguard party.
- C. Lenin revises where revolution matures, Gramsci revises how ruling ideas rule, Miliband and Poulantzas revise what the state is, and Althusser revises what a subject is.
- D. Althusser revises the account of alienation, Miliband revises hegemony, Poulantzas revises democratic centralism and Gramsci revises the labour theory of value.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: every pairing is displaced by one position, and imperialism is Lenin's own contribution rather than a claim Gramsci revises.
- **B:** Incorrect: the location of revolution is Lenin's revision and the theory of the subject is Althusser's, so the two are transposed here.

- **C:** Correct: this reproduces C1 to C4 exactly - the maturation of revolution, the reflex theory of ruling ideas, the instrumental state, and the determination of consciousness by social being.
- **D:** Incorrect: Althusser displaces the humanist categories rather than revising alienation as a claim, and none of the remaining three pairings is supported.

Examiner trap 21: Running Marx, Lenin, Gramsci and Althusser together as "the Marxist view" loses marks twice - once for imprecision and once for missing the internal debate where the analytical interest of the tradition lies.

MCQ 22. Gramsci against Althusser

Both give the superstructure real causal weight. What is the difference an examiner rewards?

- A. Gramsci confines his analysis to Italy while Althusser generalises to all capitalist societies, so their competing claims differ in scope rather than in explanatory content.
- B. Gramsci treats ideology as false belief while Althusser treats it as true belief that happens to serve the interests of the particular class that propagates it most effectively.
- C. Gramsci writes only about the state while Althusser writes about the economy, so the two occupy different levels of the base-superstructure relation without ever competing.
- D. Gramsci's civil society is a terrain of contest where hegemony can be lost and counter-hegemony built, while Althusser's apparatuses are primarily mechanisms of reproduction.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: both frameworks are general, and the difference concerns the distribution of agency rather than the geographical range of the claims.
- **B:** Incorrect: neither treats ideology as a matter of belief being true or false, since for Gramsci it is leadership and for Althusser a material practice.
- **C:** Incorrect: both are theories of the superstructure, and Althusser's apparatuses include the state as well as private institutions.
- **D:** Correct: Gramsci therefore leaves more room for agency and political strategy, while Althusser explains stability more powerfully and struggles to explain change.

Examiner trap 22: Merging the two into a single "neo-Marxist theory of ideology" erases the strategic difference between a theory that generates a war of position and one that explains why strategies so often fail.

MCQ 23. The internal limit of relative autonomy

Why must the qualifier in "relative autonomy" be stated explicitly in any answer on the Marxist theory of the state?

- A. Because a state autonomous from class power in the last instance is simply the pluralist state under another name, so the analysis would cease to be Marxist.
- B. Because Poulantzas uses the term only provisionally and later abandons it, so an unqualified use misrepresents the development of his own position over time.
- C. Because Miliband accepts relative autonomy as well, so the qualifier is what distinguishes the two writers from one another in the exchange between them.
- D. Because the term originates in Althusser's account of overdetermination, so using it without qualification imports a structuralist commitment the writer may not intend.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the debate's value lies precisely in this boundary, since autonomy must be sufficient to explain regulation and concession yet bounded enough to preserve the class analysis.
- **B:** Incorrect: the qualifier is integral to the position rather than provisional, and the exchange turns on defending relative autonomy rather than on abandoning it.

- **C:** Incorrect: Miliband treats apparent autonomy as disguised capture, so the two are distinguished by whether autonomy is real rather than by the qualifier alone.
- **D:** Incorrect: overdetermination is a related structuralist device, but the qualifier's function here is to bound the state's independence rather than to signal an allegiance.

Examiner trap 23: Dropping the qualifier turns a Marxist argument into a pluralist one in a single sentence, and an examiner reading "the state is autonomous" has no way of knowing that a bounded claim was intended.

MCQ 24. Socialism as a family, and the ownership control

Which statement most accurately captures socialism's family character and its central institutional caution?

- A. Socialism is the doctrine that all productive property should be owned by the state, and its central caution is that private ownership must be extinguished quickly to prevent restoration.
- B. Socialism is a family of doctrines subjecting productive property to social control by several routes, and its central caution is that nationalisation is not automatically socialisation.
- C. Socialism is the moderate wing of Marxism, and its central caution is that reforms should never be attempted before the productive forces have matured sufficiently for transition.
- D. Socialism is a programme of welfare provision financed by taxation, and its central caution is that public services must be universal rather than targeted at the poorest groups.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: identifying socialism with state ownership is the error the family definition exists to prevent, since guild, market, cooperative and Gandhian variants reject it.
- **B:** Correct: the family may proceed by revolution or parliament, planning or regulated markets, state ownership or cooperatives, and the control sentence distinguishes transfer of title from effective social control.
- **C:** Incorrect: socialism is wider than Marxism rather than a wing of it, and several variants predate or reject Marx's account of maturation altogether.
- **D:** Incorrect: tax-financed welfare provision describes social democracy, which retains private property under regulation rather than subjecting it to social control.

Examiner trap 24: Treating a public sector, a cooperative or a welfare scheme as proof of socialism substitutes an institutional illustration for the philosophical question of who actually decides about investment and production.

MCQ 25. Remedial - socialism and communism are not synonyms

A 2024-pattern stem asks the candidate to compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies. Which opening move is required?

- A. Asserting that communism is simply socialism carried to its logical conclusion, and then describing the additional measures the further stage would require.
- B. Declaring the vocabulary sense in use, since in Marxist usage socialism often names a transitional lower phase while in wider political theory it names the whole family.
- C. Establishing which countries have described themselves as socialist and which as communist, and comparing the institutional records the two labels have produced.
- D. Explaining that the two words are interchangeable in ordinary political language, and that the stem therefore rests on a distinction without any real philosophical content.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: presenting communism as socialism intensified is exactly the conflation the stem is testing, and it removes the property, state, distribution and method differences.
- **B:** Correct: declaring the sense prevents the answer from equivocating halfway through, and stating the ambiguity explicitly is itself a mark-bearing move.

- **C:** Incorrect: an institutional survey answers an empirical question, and the stem asks about two ideologies rather than about two sets of states.
- **D:** Incorrect: the distinction is substantive on all four axes, and denying it abandons the comparison the stem requires.

Examiner trap 25: Using "socialism" and "communism" interchangeably without specifying vocabulary and phase makes every subsequent contrast unstable, because the same word is doing two different jobs in the same answer.

MCQ 26. Remedial - what "utopian" and "scientific" actually classify

What do the labels "utopian socialism" and "scientific socialism" distinguish, and what do they not establish?

- A. They distinguish moral-exemplary from material-historical strategies of transformation, and they do not establish that the first is impracticable or the second predictively certain.
- B. They distinguish earlier from later socialists in strict chronological order, and they do not establish anything at all about the actual content of the doctrines so classified.
- C. They distinguish socialists who failed from socialists who succeeded, and they do not establish why the successful group achieved what the earlier group could not achieve.
- D. They distinguish religious from secular socialists, and they do not establish whether spiritual motivation is compatible with a materialist account of history.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: utopian socialism proceeds by exemplary communities and moral plans without a developed theory of class struggle, while scientific socialism claims a material-historical explanation - and neither label settles feasibility or certainty.
- **B:** Incorrect: chronology correlates with the labels but does not define them, and a later moral-exemplary proposal would still be utopian in the methodological sense.
- **C:** Incorrect: success and failure are not what the labels classify, and treating them so imports an empirical judgment the terms do not carry.
- **D:** Incorrect: the religious/secular contrast cuts across the pair, as Gandhian socialism shows by combining spiritual ethics with a definite theory of transformation.

Examiner trap 26: Reading "utopian" as foolish and "scientific" as infallible converts a methodological classification into a verdict, and it makes Owen, Fourier and Saint-Simon look like a preliminary error rather than a distinct strategy.

MCQ 27. Remedial - Gandhian socialism and the objection it must face

Which treatment of Gandhian socialism meets the standard a 2021-pattern stem requires?

- A. Listing non-possession, trusteeship, bread labour and village self-rule, and concluding that Gandhian socialism avoids every objection that Marxian and Fabian socialism face.
- B. Presenting trusteeship as a fully worked institutional mechanism with enforcement provisions, and treating the voluntary element as an administrative detail of implementation.
- C. Treating Gandhian socialism as a variety of welfare policy, and evaluating it by the coverage and adequacy of the provision it would deliver to the poorest households.
- D. Setting out its six elements and its means-ends argument, then conceding that trusteeship relies on voluntary moral conversion and may preserve unequal ownership.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the list without the objection produces an advocacy answer, and the stem's second half on contemporary relevance cannot be argued without the qualification.
- **B:** Incorrect: the absence of enforceable institutions is precisely what makes the objection powerful, so describing it as an administrative detail concedes nothing and explains nothing.
- **C:** Incorrect: this evaluates a philosophy of property and production by a policy metric, and it removes the non-violence and decentralisation commitments that define the variant.
- **D:** Correct: Gandhi treats trusteeship as a non-violent direction of transition rather than praise of possessive entitlement, and the objection nonetheless remains powerful without enforceable institutions.

Examiner trap 27: Presenting Gandhian socialism without the voluntary-conversion objection produces a description that cannot answer the relevance half of the stem, since relevance is precisely a judgment about what survives objection.

MCQ 28. Remedial - what this clause does not own

Which set of items is correctly excluded from this owner as the sources fix the boundary?

- A. Alienation, historical materialism and surplus value, all of which belong to Social and Political Ideals because they concern equality and justice rather than ideology.
- B. Anarchism's strands, Gandhian socialism and the utopian socialists, all of which belong to Development and Social Progress because they concern models of social improvement.
- C. Fascism as a printed family, liberalism and neoliberalism as full doctrines, the 2022 Marxian equity part, and the full civil-disobedience ladder.
- D. Lenin, Gramsci and Althusser, all of whom belong to Forms of Government because their subject matter is the state and the exercise of political power.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: alienation, historical materialism and surplus value are core owned doctrine here, and only the 2022 equity-against-equality demand is routed to Ideals.
- **B:** Incorrect: anarchist strands, Gandhian socialism and the utopians are all owned here, with only development programmes and progress metrics routed elsewhere.
- **C:** Correct: fascism is neither printed nor routed by any 2018 to 2025 part, liberalism and neoliberalism are comparison foils only, the 2022 equity part belongs to Ideals, and the disobedience ladder belongs to Individual and State.
- **D:** Incorrect: the three neo-Marxists are admitted here because owned parts on Marxism's relevance, ideology and the state cannot be answered without them.

Examiner trap 28: Importing fascism as a fourth printed ideology spends time on unowned material and risks a false equivalence between fascism and the three printed families that the sources explicitly forbid.

MCQ 29. Remedial - the provenance the paper can punish

Which set of attributions is accurate, with the dates the repository verifies?

- A. Marx's *Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts* 1844, the *Manifesto* 1848, the 1859 Preface, the *Critique of the Gotha Programme* 1875, Miliband 1969 and Poulantzas 1973.
- B. Marx's *Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts* 1859, the *Manifesto* 1875, the *Critique of the Gotha Programme* 1844, Miliband 1973 and Poulantzas 1969, with Gramsci's notebooks dated to 1926.
- C. Proudhon's *What Is Property?* 1840, Bakunin's *Statism and Anarchy* 1873, Kropotkin's *Mutual Aid* 1902 and Godwin's *Political Justice* 1793, each cited with page references to the standard editions.
- D. Lenin's *What Is To Be Done?* 1902, Gramsci's *Prison Notebooks* 1929, Althusser's essay on ideological state apparatuses 1970 and Engels's *Socialism: Utopian and Scientific* 1880.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: these are exactly the six dated items the package treats as examinable provenance, and each is cited by title and year without page, chapter or edition.
- **B:** Incorrect: every date is displaced, and the notebooks carry no asserted date in this package at all.
- **C:** Incorrect: no date is asserted for Proudhon, Bakunin, Kropotkin or Godwin here, and page references to standard editions are expressly forbidden.
- **D:** Incorrect: no date is asserted for Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser or Engels in this package, so supplying them invents provenance the sources do not support.

Examiner trap 29: Attaching confident dates to Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Proudhon, Bakunin or Kropotkin manufactures precision the sources do not warrant, and a single invented year is more damaging than an honest citation by title alone.

MCQ 30. Remedial - using India without characterising any actor

How may the Directive Principles of State Policy be used in an answer in this clause?

- A. As proof that the Indian state is relatively autonomous from capital, since non-justiciable directives could not otherwise survive alongside constitutional property protections.
- B. As evidence that Marxian socialism has been partially implemented in India, since Articles 38 and 39 adopt the language of minimising inequalities of income and status.
- C. As dated, non-justiciable constitutional facts illustrating what a state committed to social transformation on paper looks like, after which the philosophy is argued separately.
- D. As a demonstration that Gandhian socialism prevailed over Marxian socialism in the Constituent Assembly, since decentralisation appears alongside redistributive language.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: their presence in the text is a legal fact that neither proves relative autonomy nor proves instrumental capture, and using them so settles by assertion what must be argued.
- **B:** Incorrect: constitutional language does not establish that a doctrine has been implemented, and no claim about any Indian government or period may be made here.
- **C:** Correct: Part IV, including Articles 38, 39 and 43, is used as a dated constitutional illustration only, with the philosophical question argued on its own ground.
- **D:** Incorrect: this attributes an outcome to a historical body and characterises a period, both of which the discipline of this clause forbids.

Examiner trap 30: Using a statute, scheme or judgment as evidence that a Marxist or socialist thesis is true confuses what a state has enacted with what its class character is, and it converts a philosophy answer into an uncited empirical claim.

MCQ 31. Remedial - the anarchist-Marxist exchange, stated honestly

How should the dispute between Bakunin's warning and the Marxist reply be presented?

- A. As settled in Bakunin's favour, since transitional states have historically entrenched themselves rather than withered and the anarchist prediction has therefore been confirmed.
- B. As genuinely unresolved, since Bakunin predicts a new ruling stratum while Marxists reply that abolishing organisation disperses power unaccountably rather than removing it.
- C. As settled in the Marxists' favour, since no anarchist federation has ever coordinated a complex modern economy and the burden of proof therefore lies with the proposer.
- D. As a merely verbal disagreement, since both sides oppose domination and differ only in the vocabulary they use to describe the institutions they would ultimately accept.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the historical record is a serious objection to the transitional argument, but the reply that unaccountable dispersal is also domination has not been answered by that record.
- **B:** Correct: each side identifies a real danger created by the other's remedy, and the sources present the exchange as unresolved rather than as decided.
- **C:** Incorrect: absence of a demonstrated federation supports the scale objection without touching Bakunin's prediction about concentrated revolutionary authority.
- **D:** Incorrect: the disagreement concerns whether transitional sovereignty is necessary or self-defeating, which is a substantive institutional question rather than a verbal one.

Examiner trap 31: Declaring the exchange settled in either direction removes the strongest available demonstration of critical control, because an unresolved dispute stated as unresolved is worth more than a confident verdict that ignores half the argument.

MCQ 32. Remedial - how a relevance stem must be structured

A stem asks how far Marxism remains relevant, or what its future is under a prevailing free-market economy. What structure does the package prescribe?

- A. A survey of contemporary economic conditions in several different countries, followed by a judgment about whether those conditions resemble the ones Marx originally described.
- B. An account of the collapse of the communist regimes, followed by an assessment of whether any state today could plausibly adopt a fully Marxist political programme.
- C. A defence of Marx against his critics, followed by a demonstration that each one of the standard objections rests on a misunderstanding of the original texts.
- D. Three columns - what the analysis still explains, what it failed to predict, and what its institutional record forecloses - with no verdict offered on any country.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a survey of conditions supplies illustrations rather than an argument about relevance, and it invites empirical claims the clause forbids.
- **B:** Incorrect: this answers a question about political feasibility rather than about the doctrine's explanatory and normative standing.
- **C:** Incorrect: a defence that dissolves every objection into misunderstanding refuses the critical layer on which such stems are scored.
- **D:** Correct: the three-column judgment separates diagnostic power from predictive success and from institutional record, which is precisely what "how far" and "future of" stems require.

Examiner trap 32: Answering a relevance stem with contemporary examples instead of an argument produces a description of the present that never states which of Marx's claims the present supports and which it embarrasses.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper II. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the paper's own spacing before the question mark in **"Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer."** and **"Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically."**, and the paper's own capitalisation in **"Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology."** - all preserved verbatim inside the question lines. The 2018 to 2025 Paper II texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below follows the repository's verified Socio-Political PYQ ledger. Provenance is treated as examinable: **Marx, Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts, 1844; Marx and Engels, Manifesto of the Communist Party, 1848; Marx, Preface to A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy, 1859; Marx, Critique of the Gotha Programme, 1875; Miliband, The State in Capitalist Society, 1969; Poulantzas, Political Power and Social Classes, 1973; the Constitution of India, Part IV, Articles 38, 39 and 43**, which are non-justiciable. No page, chapter, edition or invented quotation is asserted for Godwin, Proudhon, Bakunin, Kropotkin, Tolstoy, Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Engels, Owen, Fourier, Saint-Simon, Gandhi or M. N. Roy, and no date is asserted for any of them. ANALYSIS: Interpretive disputes - whether the base-superstructure relation retains a determinate commitment once reciprocal effects are allowed, whether species-being can be reconstructed without a universal human essence, whether relative autonomy can be bounded short of pluralism, and whether Gandhi's ideal should be classified as anarchism or as ethical decentralist socialism - are flagged as contested rather than settled. WRONG: No empirical claim is made about any country, party, government, leader, period or class, Indian or otherwise, and no Indian statute, scheme or judgment is used as evidence for or against a philosophical thesis.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper II parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands used here are **10 marks - about 150 to 220 words, 15 marks - about 250 to 330 words, and 20 marks - about 330 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** this clause owns **13 of 112** Socio-Political question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, distributed **2018: 2, 2019: 2, 2020: 2, 2021: 2, 2022: 0, 2023: 2, 2024: 2, 2025: 1**. All thirteen are solved in full below, followed by **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal distribution is worth knowing before the examination: **anarchism** carries four parts (2018 Q2(c), 2020 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(a), 2023 Q1(b)); **Gandhi** carries two (2019 Q1(c), 2021 Q3(b)); **Marxism** carries six (2018 Q3(b), 2019 Q3(c), 2020 Q2(b), 2023 Q3(a), 2024 Q1(d), 2025 Q2(b)); and **socialism as a family** carries two, one of which is shared with Gandhi (2024 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b)). ANALYSIS: Ownership discipline: the 2022 Marxian equity-against-equality 15-marker belongs to **Social and Political Ideals**; the 2021 unconditional-rights-and-anarchy part to **Individual and State**; the 2020 Gandhian social-development 20-marker to **Development and Social Progress**; the 2019 gender-equality-under-socialism part to **Gender Discrimination**; and the Gandhi-Ambedkar caste parts to **Caste Discrimination**. None of those is counted here. WRONG: Do not route every occurrence of the words "state", "freedom" or "equality" to this owner: ownership turns on the printed families - anarchism, Marxism and socialism - and on the diagnoses of domination they generate.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	First person, argued: take a position and justify it, not survey the doctrine
Core issue	Whether the anarchist critique of standing authority can be endorsed, and how far
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: define, state the argument, take a graded position, concede the residual
Key distinction	Anarchy against anarchism; the negative claim against the institutional claim
Non-negotiables	The burden-of-justification argument; philosophical anarchism as the defensible strand; hidden authority as the residual

Independent model answer

Position, stated first. ANALYSIS: I subscribe to the anarchist **critique of authority** and to its philosophical form, and not to its institutional programme in the strong sense.

What the doctrine is. FACT: Anarchism holds that coercive political authority, paradigmatically the sovereign state, lacks adequate moral justification, and that order can be organised through voluntary association, mutual aid, federation and self-government. FACT: Anarchy - the absence or collapse of rule - is a condition; anarchism is a doctrine that proposes non-coercive order.

The argument I accept. FACT: Legitimate authority must be compatible with the moral autonomy and equality of persons. The state claims a territorial monopoly of law-making, coercion and punishment, and demands obedience because a command is legally authoritative rather than because its content is independently right. Such a standing right subordinates one person's judgment to another's institutional will. ANALYSIS: The conclusion I therefore accept is the **philosophical anarchist** one: there is no automatic duty to obey, and every law must earn compliance on independent grounds.

Why I stop there. ANALYSIS: Three objections are answered by relocating the dispute to accountability - the security dilemma, the scale objection and the appeal to human selfishness, since anarchists need only deny that hierarchy is the unique or best remedy. ANALYSIS: The fourth is not answered: expertise, informal status and economic power return after the state disappears, and a defensible anarchism must scrutinise domination inside voluntary associations rather than merely abolish offices.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The critique of unearned standing authority is sound and the abolitionist programme is unproved; the defensible position is radical decentralisation with recall and function-by-function justification.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a first-person stem is scored on the **grading** of the position, not on its direction. Scripts that describe anarchism and then add "however, it is impractical" have not taken a position; scripts that endorse abolition without meeting the scale and hidden-authority objections have taken an indefensible one.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: position two lines; doctrine and the anarchy discrimination three; the accepted argument four; the three answered objections and the conceded one four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** position -> doctrine with the anarchy/anarchism line -> the five-step argument -> three objections relocated, one conceded -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the burden of justification; philosophical anarchism as a claim about legitimacy rather than institutions.
- **Evidence:** content-independence as the load-bearing premise; hidden authority as the internal challenge.
- **Distinction:** critique of authority against abolitionist programme; condition against doctrine.
- **Criticism:** the concession that the positive institutional claim remains unproved at scale.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2018 · Q3(b) · 15 marks

Question: Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Discuss critically" - the objection-and-reply layer is the answer, not an appendix
Core issue	Whether collective ownership enlarges or extinguishes individual freedom
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: define both terms, argue the conditional, test it, conclude
Key distinction	Freedom as non-interference against freedom as non-domination plus self-development
Non-negotiables	The conditional verdict; the bureaucratic-command failure mode; Roy's internal criticism

Independent model answer

Fix the concept of freedom first. ANALYSIS: The stem is decided by which conception is in play. FACT: For Marx, freedom is **non-domination together with self-development**, not merely the absence of interference; the question "freedom from whom, and for what activity?" is therefore prior.

The case for consistency. FACT: Marx criticises equal legal right where formally identical rules operate over radically unequal social conditions: formal liberty coexists with structural dependence when workers lack independent access to the means of production. FACT: On this account collective ownership is not a restriction on freedom but its material precondition, since it removes the standing power of some over others' work and life-chances.

The case against. ANALYSIS: Collective ownership specifies who does *not* own; it does not by itself specify who decides. Where "collective" power becomes bureaucratic command, the worker exchanges a private superior for an official one, and the standing subjection that the concept of freedom was introduced to remove reappears intact. FACT: M. N. Roy states the internal criticism precisely: dictatorship cannot reliably serve emancipation, because concentrated power reproduces domination.

The conditional verdict. ANALYSIS: Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent **only if** collective ownership enlarges real self-development and democratic control. If it does not, the emancipatory claim defeats itself.

Residual. CAUTION: Marx supplies no institutional mechanism guaranteeing the condition, and the *Critique of the Gotha Programme* two-phase account is a normative projection rather than a demonstrated law.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the mark-bearing move is refusing both flat answers. A "yes" ignores the bureaucratic failure mode; a "no" tacitly assumes a non-interference conception of freedom that Marx explicitly rejects, and therefore answers a different question.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: freedom concept two lines; case for four; case against four; conditional verdict two; residual two.

- **Structure:** define freedom -> case for -> case against -> conditional verdict -> residual.
- **Doctrine:** non-domination plus self-development; equal right over unequal conditions.
- **Evidence:** lack of independent access to the means of production; Roy on concentrated power.
- **Distinction:** who does not own against who decides.
- **Criticism:** the absence of any internal guarantee that the condition will be met.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2019 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Evaluate" - a graded fit, not a yes/no classification
Core issue	Whether Gandhi's ideal and method both belong to the anarchist family
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the affinity, the breaks, the formula
Key distinction	End-state against method
Non-negotiables	Swarāj and village republics; the four breaks; the qualified formula

Independent model answer

The affinity. FACT: Gandhi's ideal of self-rule (*swarāj*) begins with mastery of desire, non-violence and local self-government: merely transferring rulers does not secure freedom. His preference for decentralised village republics and a state reduced to a minimum places his **end-state** recognisably within the anarchist family.

The breaks. ANALYSIS: Four differences prevent identification with Bakuninite anarchism. Non-violence is constitutive rather than tactical, so revolutionary violence is closed off. **Trusteeship** reforms ownership instead of abolishing it. Religious ethics replace anti-theism. And the **constructive programme** substitutes social reconstruction for insurrection.

Why the division is principled. ANALYSIS: It follows from Gandhi's own doctrine that means prefigure ends: a violent, centralising route cannot produce a non-violent, decentralised order. The same principle that makes his ideal anarchist makes his method gradualist.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Gandhi is a **moral and decentralist anarchist in ideal**, but a **pragmatic reformer in political method**. CAUTION: Whether an ideal never to be reached by anarchist means should count as anarchism, or as ethical decentralist socialism, remains contested.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem says "evaluate", so the marks lie in locating exactly where the description fits. The efficient structure is affinity -> breaks -> the principle that explains the split -> qualified formula.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: affinity three lines; breaks four; the means-ends principle two; verdict two.

- **Structure:** affinity -> four breaks -> means-ends explanation -> qualified verdict.
- **Doctrine:** swarāj, village republics, minimal state, trusteeship, constructive programme.
- **Evidence:** the four structural breaks, each named rather than summarised.
- **Distinction:** end-state against method.
- **Criticism:** the open classification question, stated as contested rather than resolved.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2019 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	A judgment about prospects, argued from the doctrine's explanatory standing
Core issue	What survives when the free market is the prevailing form rather than the contested one
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: three columns, then a forward judgment
Key distinction	Diagnostic reach against predictive success against institutional record
Non-negotiables	The three-column judgment; hegemony and ideological reproduction; no country verdict

Independent model answer

Frame. ANALYSIS: "Future" cannot mean political prospects, which would require empirical claims about states and parties. It means what the framework can still be expected to explain, and where it must be reconstructed.

What survives. FACT: The structural core is untouched by market prevalence, and in some respects sharpened by it: exploitation as a relation arising from a formally free contract; alienation across product, activity, species-being and other persons; commodity relations extending into new spheres; and the concentration of economic power. FACT: Ideology as a naturalising framework, and Gramsci's account of consent secured through the institutions of civil society, explain precisely why a prevailing market order requires little coercion to reproduce itself.

What must be conceded. ANALYSIS: The predictive element has failed twice over: revolution did not mature where capitalism was most advanced, and the welfare compromise proved durable. ANALYSIS: The transitional programme fares worse still, since transitional states have entrenched rather than withered, and the model supplies no mechanism subordinating party to class.

What must be reconstructed. ANALYSIS: Two repairs are available inside the tradition: relative autonomy, which explains state action against particular capitalists without abandoning class analysis, and the concession that class analysis is necessary but insufficient where caste and gender operate through distinct mechanisms of status, endogamy and social reproduction.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Marxism's future is as a **critical diagnostic framework** rather than as a transitional programme: its analysis of exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force, while its institutional prescriptions require safeguards its own theory of the state told it not to expect. WRONG: No claim is made about any country.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "future" stems tempt candidates into prediction. Converting the question into a judgment about explanatory standing, and separating diagnosis from prediction from institutional record, is what keeps the answer philosophical.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: frame two lines; survives four; conceded three; reconstructed three; verdict two.

- **Structure:** reframe -> what survives -> what is conceded -> what must be reconstructed -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** exploitation, alienation, ideology, hegemony, relative autonomy.
- **Evidence:** the formally free contract; consent through civil society; the durability of the welfare compromise.
- **Distinction:** diagnostic framework against transitional programme.
- **Criticism:** the missing internal safeguard, stated as the reason the programme rather than the analysis is in difficulty.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2020 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

Question: Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Do you think ... Discuss" - a position with the conceptual ground stated
Core issue	Whether a crisis can convert a society to an ideology
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the discrimination, the three-way control, the verdict
Key distinction	Anarchy as a condition against anarchism as a doctrine
Non-negotiables	The discrimination; the observation that expanded state power points the other way

Independent model answer

The discrimination that decides the question. FACT: **Anarchy** is the absence or collapse of effective rule and may mean disorder. **Anarchism** is a normative critique of domination that proposes non-coercive order through voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. A crisis can produce the first; only argument and commitment produce the second.

Three things a crisis can produce at once. ANALYSIS: Temporary **disorder**; markedly **expanded state power** through emergency regulation; and widespread **mutual-aid practices**. ANALYSIS: Note that these do not point in one direction: the second runs directly against the first and third, which is the observation that converts a description into an argument.

Why mutual aid is not adoption of an ideology. FACT: Anarchism's institutional claim is that order **may** emerge from reciprocity, custom, association and horizontal coordination without a final coercive superior. Emergency cooperation illustrates a limited capacity for non-sovereign coordination; it does not establish that a complex society can dispense with public authority, and it is generally practised alongside, not instead of, state provision.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: No. A pandemic may generate anarchy in the descriptive sense and may vindicate anarchist claims about mutual aid, while simultaneously strengthening the centralised authority anarchism opposes. ANALYSIS: Disorder is not ideology, and a society does not adopt a doctrine by undergoing a crisis.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem is a trap built on one word. The whole answer is decided in the opening two lines, and the three-way control is what prevents the rest from becoming a description of the crisis.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: discrimination three lines; the three effects three; the mutual-aid limit two; verdict two.

- **Structure:** discrimination -> three simultaneous effects -> why mutual aid is not adoption -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** anarchism's negative, positive and institutional claims.
- **Evidence:** the limited-capacity rule for every anarchist illustration.
- **Distinction:** condition against doctrine; illustration against proof.
- **Criticism:** the concession that the crisis does vindicate part of the anarchist case even while refuting the stem's inference.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2020 · Q2(b) · 15 marks

Question: How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How far ... justify" - a degree judgment with reasons, not an absolute
Core issue	Which parts of the doctrine retain philosophical force
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: separate the aspects, grade each, conclude conditionally
Key distinction	Philosophical doctrine against political programme
Non-negotiables	The four aspects; the three-column judgment; necessary-but-insufficient in India

Independent model answer

Read the stem exactly. ANALYSIS: It asks about Marxism **as a philosophical doctrine**, which licenses a judgment about method and critique rather than about parties or regimes.

Separate the four aspects. FACT: Marxism is simultaneously a **method** - dialectical and historical analysis; a **critique** - of exploitation, alienation, commodity relations and ideology; a **theory of change** - contradiction and class struggle; and a **political project** - collective emancipation through transformed property and power relations. A single verdict on all four is not available.

Grade them. FACT: The method retains force in its defensible form: no society's law, politics or ideology can long remain incompatible with the way it reproduces its material life. FACT: The critique retains most force of all, since exploitation as a structural relation under a free contract, and alienation across the four dimensions, are not answered by higher wages. ANALYSIS: The theory of change is weakened, since revolution did not mature where capitalism was most advanced. ANALYSIS: The political project is weakest, since transitional states entrenched rather than withered.

Where it must be supplemented. ANALYSIS: In India class analysis is **necessary but insufficient**: caste and patriarchy operate through distinct mechanisms of status, endogamy and social reproduction that cannot be derived from class alone. The right conclusion is diagnostic alliance, not explanatory monopoly.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Marxism is substantially relevant as method and critique, partially relevant as a theory of change, and least defensible as a transitional programme - and the honest answer to "how far" is therefore *unevenly, and by aspect*.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "how far" forbids both "fully" and "not at all". Grading by aspect is the device that makes a degree judgment precise rather than evasive, and it is visible in the answer's structure.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: reading the stem two lines; four aspects three; grading five; India two; verdict two.

- **Structure:** read the stem -> four aspects -> grade each -> the Indian supplement -> uneven verdict.
- **Doctrine:** method, critique, theory of change, political project.
- **Evidence:** the free contract; the four dimensions of alienation; the entrenchment of transitional states.
- **Distinction:** philosophical doctrine against political programme.
- **Criticism:** the necessary-but-insufficient concession, stated as alliance rather than defeat.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2021 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: exposition of the ideology, then an argued answer to a possibility question
Core issue	Whether the abolition of formal office removes standing power
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: six-component placement, the argument, the objections, the possibility verdict
Key distinction	Radical decentralisation against complete dispensability
Non-negotiables	The burden-of-justification argument; the scale and hidden-authority objections; the qualified negative

Independent model answer

Anarchism as an ideology. FACT: Anarchism satisfies the test of a political ideology: it describes persons as autonomous and cooperative agents exposed to hierarchy; it **diagnoses** domination in coercive authority itself; it **evaluates** through non-domination and equal standing; it takes a definite view of property, authority and the state; it prescribes prefigurative practice, federation and direct action; and it projects a regulative picture of voluntary order.

The core argument. FACT: Legitimate authority must be compatible with the moral autonomy and equality of persons; the state claims a territorial monopoly of law-making, coercion and punishment; obedience is demanded because a command is legally authoritative rather than because its content is right; such a standing right subordinates judgment to institutional will; therefore the state bears a burden of justification anarchists judge it unable to discharge. FACT: Bakunin adds that concentrated power deforms both ruler and ruled; Proudhon attacks property where it functions as a power of appropriation; Kropotkin argues that mutual aid is a genuine source of order. FACT: The strands divide on property - mutualist, collectivist, communist, individualist - and converge in rejecting an unearned standing right to command, while philosophical anarchism confines itself to denying an automatic duty to obey.

Can authority be dispensed with completely? ANALYSIS: Three objections are answerable. The security dilemma is met by observing that states have organised war and repression, and by proposing federated defence and restorative institutions. The scale objection is met by distinguishing centralised **domination** from **coordination**, since delegated, recallable and federated administration can operate across scales. The anthropological objection is met because anarchists need only deny that hierarchy is the unique or best remedy.

The objection that is not answerable. ANALYSIS: Expertise, informal status and economic power return after the state disappears, and anarchism's own defenders concede that a defensible anarchism must scrutinise domination **inside** voluntary associations rather than merely abolish formal offices. CAUTION: Whether federation and recall can discipline economic power specifically remains unproved.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Political authority can be radically decentralised, made recallable and justified function by function; it cannot be completely dispensed with, because standing power survives the abolition of office - and this conclusion is reached from the anarchist tradition's own materials rather than against them.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem has two halves and the second is a **possibility** question, which cannot be answered by preference. The winning structure gives the doctrine its strongest form and then locates precisely the objection that its own defenders concede.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: ideology placement three lines; core argument and strands six; three answerable objections four; the conceded objection three; verdict three.

- **Structure:** six-component placement -> the five-step argument with the three thinkers -> strands -> three objections relocated -> hidden authority conceded -> qualified negative.
- **Doctrine:** the burden of justification; the negative, positive and institutional claims.
- **Evidence:** Bakunin's corruption thesis; Proudhon's qualification; Kropotkin's mutual aid.

- **Distinction:** domination against coordination; decentralisation against dispensability.
- **Criticism:** the internal concession about hidden authority, used as the ground of the verdict rather than as an afterthought.

Solved PYQ 8 · 2021 · Q3(b) · 15 marks

Question: Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: distinctive features, then relevance argued rather than asserted
Core issue	What makes Gandhian socialism a socialism, and what makes it distinctive within the family
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: six elements, the means-ends argument, relevance with qualification
Key distinction	Trusteeship against both expropriation and unrestricted ownership
Non-negotiables	The six elements; the voluntary-conversion objection; the two-sided relevance verdict

Independent model answer

Placing it in the family. FACT: Socialism is the family of doctrines subjecting productive property and economic power to social control. Gandhian socialism belongs to that family while rejecting both unrestricted capitalism and violent, centralised collectivism.

The six distinctive features. FACT: **Non-possession**; **trusteeship**, under which property is held as a social obligation administered on behalf of the community; **bread labour**, which makes physical work a condition of legitimate consumption; **decentralised production**; **village self-rule (swarāj)**; and **welfare of all (sarvodaya)**, which refuses to trade the interests of the last person for an aggregate gain.

The argument. FACT: Property carries a social obligation; production should meet need without degrading labour, community or nature; and **means must embody the non-violent end**. ANALYSIS: The third premise is what makes the variant distinctive rather than merely moderate: it forbids a violent or centralising route on principle, not on grounds of prudence.

The objection. ANALYSIS: Trusteeship relies on voluntary moral conversion and may preserve unequal ownership. ANALYSIS: Gandhi's reply is that trusteeship is a non-violent **direction of transition** rather than praise of possessive entitlement - yet without enforceable institutions the objection remains powerful.

Contemporary relevance, both sides. ANALYSIS: What remains live: non-violent change; ethical means; the trusteeship critique of unlimited acquisition; decentralisation; and need-oriented production that does not degrade labour or nature. ANALYSIS: What must be qualified: voluntary conversion and small-scale production face enforcement, scale and complex-economy objections.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Gandhian socialism is strongest as a **critique of means and of unlimited acquisition** and weakest as an **enforcement mechanism**; its relevance is therefore normative and directional rather than institutional. WRONG: No Indian government, party or period is characterised.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem's second half is where scripts collapse into praise. Relevance must be argued in two columns - what survives objection and what must be qualified - or it is assertion.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: placement two lines; six features four; argument three; objection and reply three; relevance three; verdict two.

- **Structure:** family placement -> six features -> the means-ends argument -> objection and reply -> two-column relevance -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** trusteeship, bread labour, swarāj, sarvodaya, non-possession, decentralisation.
- **Evidence:** the means-ends premise as the distinguishing commitment.
- **Distinction:** direction of transition against defence of entitlement.

- **Criticism:** the enforcement gap, conceded in the verdict rather than concealed.

Solved PYQ 9 · 2023 · Q1(b) · 10 marks

Question: Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically examine" a quotation - test it, do not illustrate it
Core issue	Whether the anarchist argument supports a universal and modal claim
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the argument, the gap, the graded verdict
Key distinction	Presumption against the state against universal condemnation
Non-negotiables	The five-step argument; the over-reach diagnosis; partial endorsement

Independent model answer

What the argument actually establishes. FACT: Legitimate authority must be compatible with the moral autonomy and equality of persons; the state claims a territorial monopoly of law-making, coercion and punishment; obedience is demanded because a command is legally authoritative rather than because its content is independently right; such a standing right subordinates one person's judgment to another's institutional will; therefore the state bears a **burden of justification** which anarchists judge it unable to discharge.

The gap. ANALYSIS: Failure to discharge a burden yields a **strong presumption** against a standing right to command. The quotation asserts something stronger - a universal and modal claim covering **all** states, **always** and **everywhere**. Nothing in the chain licenses that quantifier, since the premises concern what political authority claims rather than what every state has done.

What survives. FACT: Two things survive intact: that legality is not self-validating, and that historical existence establishes nothing about moral legitimacy. ANALYSIS: Bakunin's structural point also survives - concentrated power deforms both ruler and ruled - which is a claim about tendency, not about universality.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The quotation over-reaches. The defensible anarchist thesis is that no state has discharged the burden of justifying a standing right to command, which supports a rebuttable presumption rather than a demonstration that every state at every time is unjust.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critically examine" a quotation means testing the inference from the doctrine to the wording. Locating the quantifier - *all*, *always*, *everywhere* - and asking which premise supplies it, is the analytical move.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: the argument four lines; the gap three; what survives two; verdict two.

- **Structure:** the five-step argument -> the quantifier gap -> what survives -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the burden of justification; content-independence.
- **Evidence:** Bakunin's corruption thesis as a tendency claim rather than a universal one.
- **Distinction:** presumption against demonstration.
- **Criticism:** partial endorsement, which is stronger than either full agreement or dismissal.

Solved PYQ 10 · 2023 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: exposition, then a relevance judgment about development and change
Core issue	The mechanism by which one social formation gives way to another
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: five elements, the mechanism, the caution, three-column relevance
Key distinction	Conditioning against mechanical causation
Non-negotiables	The fetters mechanism; the reciprocal-effects caution; the three-column judgment

Independent model answer

Definition. FACT: Historical materialism explains social formations through the interaction of productive forces, relations of production, class structure and political-ideological institutions.

The five elements. FACT: **Productive forces** - labour-power, knowledge, tools and technology: the capacity to produce. **Relations of production** - ownership, control and class relations: who commands and who appropriates.

Mode of production - the unity of the two. **Base and superstructure** - the economic structure related to law, politics and ideology. **Class struggle** - conflict rooted in opposed structural interests, and the motor of transformation.

The mechanism, which is what "change" requires. FACT: Human beings must produce the means of life; production occurs through definite social relations; productive forces develop within those relations; existing relations eventually **obstruct** further development and become fetters; the conflict between forces and relations becomes social and political struggle; and a new mode of production can emerge through that struggle. FACT: Marx states the decisive proposition in the 1859 Preface to *A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy*.

The caution, stated before the objection. ANALYSIS: The base does not mechanically cause every idea. Marx allows reciprocal effects and political agency, and the serious criticism is a **tendency toward economic reductionism** rather than a crude determinism he never held. The theory's determinate commitment is about **long-run compatibility**: arrangements that systematically obstruct the reproduction of a mode of production do not persist.

Relevance to development and change, in three columns. FACT: What it **still explains**: the structuring of life-chances by ownership; the dependence of political possibility on material conditions; the concentration of economic power; and the ideological reproduction of arrangements as natural. ANALYSIS: What it **failed to predict**: the sequence and location of revolution, and the durability of the welfare compromise. ANALYSIS: What its **institutional record forecloses**: the unaccountable party-state as a route of transition.

Supplement. ANALYSIS: Class analysis is necessary but insufficient where caste and patriarchy operate through distinct mechanisms of status, endogamy and social reproduction.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Historical materialism remains a powerful account of **why** social orders change and a weak account of **when and where** they will - and the fetters mechanism, not the base-superstructure vocabulary, is what gives it that power. WRONG: No claim is made about any country.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: an exposition-plus-relevance stem must give the mechanism, not the vocabulary. Scripts that list five elements and then assert relevance have answered neither half properly.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: definition one line; elements four; mechanism five; caution three; three columns four; supplement and verdict three.

- **Structure:** definition -> five elements -> six-step mechanism -> the caution -> three-column relevance -> supplement -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** forces, relations, mode, base/superstructure, class struggle, fetters.
- **Evidence:** the 1859 Preface, cited by title and year with no page asserted.

- **Distinction:** why change occurs against when and where it occurs.
- **Criticism:** the reductionism tendency conceded before it is put, and the party-state foreclosure named as a foreclosure rather than a refutation.

Solved PYQ 11 · 2024 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Exposition" - internal logic, with criticism kept subordinate
Core issue	What exactly the worker is estranged from, and why it matters
Scope boundary	Ten marks: four dimensions, presupposition, the wages distinction
Key distinction	Alienation against low pay, and against exploitation
Non-negotiables	All four dimensions in order; the 1844 source; the well-paid-worker line

Independent model answer

Source and definition. FACT: In the *Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts of 1844*, Marx argues that capitalist labour estranges the worker in four connected ways.

The four dimensions. FACT: First, **from the product**: what is made confronts the producer as another's property. Second, **from the activity of labour**: work is externally compelled rather than self-realising. Third, **from species-being**: conscious creative activity, the distinctively human capacity, is reduced to a means of survival. Fourth, **from other persons**: workers are set in competition and social relations assume commodity form.

The order is a derivation. ANALYSIS: The first two concern the worker's relation to what is made and to the making; the third generalises to the capacity those two frustrate; the fourth returns the frustration to the social world.

The presupposition. FACT: Human flourishing includes conscious, social and creative activity, not merely preference-satisfaction. This is what makes alienation a loss rather than a neutral fact about industrial organisation.

The distinction that carries the concept. FACT: Alienation is broader than low wages: a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others. ANALYSIS: It is also distinct from exploitation, which concerns appropriation of the product rather than dispossession of the activity.

Note. CAUTION: The species-being dimension is contested as presupposing a universal human essence; it can be reconstructed minimally as the requirement of meaningful agency, social recognition and control over central activities.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: an exposition stem is scored on completeness and order, not on criticism. The one permitted critical line is the species-being caveat, and it belongs at the end.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: source one line; four dimensions four; derivation one; presupposition two; distinctions two; caveat one.

- **Structure:** source -> four dimensions in order -> why the order is a derivation -> presupposition -> the two distinctions -> contested caveat.
- **Doctrine:** estranged labour in four dimensions; species-being.
- **Evidence:** the 1844 Manuscripts, cited by title and year only.
- **Distinction:** alienation against low wages, and alienation against exploitation.
- **Criticism:** the essentialism objection with its minimal reconstruction, kept subordinate as an exposition stem requires.

Solved PYQ 12 · 2024 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

Question: Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Compare ... as two distinct" - parallel axes, and the distinctness must be established
Core issue	Whether the two differ in kind or only in degree
Scope boundary	Ten marks: declare the vocabulary, run four axes, conclude
Key distinction	Socialism as a family against communism as a specific end-state
Non-negotiables	The vocabulary declaration; four axes; the non-synonymy verdict

Independent model answer

Declare the vocabulary first. ANALYSIS: In Marxist usage "socialism" often names a transitional lower phase; in wider political theory it names the whole family. This answer uses the wider sense, and the distinction is drawn against communism as the Marxian higher phase.

Four axes. FACT: **Property:** socialism means social control in varied forms - public, cooperative, guild, worker or mixed; communism means common control with classes abolished. FACT: **State:** socialism may retain a democratic and active state; communism expects the political state, as an instrument of class domination, to lose that function. FACT: **Distribution:** socialism may use contribution, need or mixed principles; communism distributes according to need in the higher phase. FACT: **Method:** socialism may be revolutionary or gradual; communism is reached through transition.

Why they are distinct in kind. ANALYSIS: Socialism is a **family** admitting utopian, Marxian, Fabian, guild, market and Gandhian members, and leaves the state, the distributive principle and the method open. Communism specifies all three. A doctrine that leaves questions open is not a milder version of one that closes them.

Control. FACT: Neither is identical with **social democracy**, which retains private property under regulation, operates a welfare-regulatory state and proceeds by constitutional reform.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: They are distinct ideologies rather than stages of one another; using them as synonyms makes every contrast in the answer unstable.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "compare as two distinct" requires the distinctness to be argued, not assumed. The vocabulary declaration is the move that prevents equivocation, and the fourth term - social democracy - shows control of the neighbourhood.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: vocabulary two lines; four axes four; distinctness in kind two; control one; verdict one.

- **Structure:** declare the sense -> four axes -> why the difference is one of kind -> social democracy as control -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the family definition; the Marxian higher phase.
- **Evidence:** the six socialist variants as proof of family character.
- **Distinction:** open questions against specified answers.
- **Criticism:** the acknowledgement that the boundary is historically fluid, handled by declaring the sense at the outset.

Solved PYQ 13 · 2025 · Q2(b) · 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Evaluate" - grade the doctrine, and the word "ideology" is itself scored
Core issue	Whether Marxism satisfies the test of an ideology, and how it performs on each aspect
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the six-component placement, the four aspects, the graded verdict
Key distinction	Ideology in the analytical sense against ideology in the critical sense
Non-negotiables	The double placement; four aspects graded separately; the residual

Independent model answer

Take the word seriously. ANALYSIS: Marxism occupies **both** senses of "ideology" at once, and saying so is the opening move. In the **analytical** sense it is an avowed, argued, action-guiding structure; in the **critical** sense it is the theory that explains how historically specific relations come to appear natural, universal and inevitable.

The six-component placement. FACT: It **describes** persons as social producers formed within class relations; **diagnoses** domination in the class relation generated by the mode of production; **evaluates** through non-domination and non-alienated self-development; takes a definite view of **property, authority and the state**; prescribes **class struggle and revolutionary transition**; and projects a **classless order**. It therefore satisfies the test fully.

Grade the four aspects. FACT: As **method**, historical materialism's fetters mechanism retains force in its defensible, non-mechanical form. FACT: As **critique**, exploitation under a formally free contract and alienation across four dimensions remain unanswered by higher wages or redistribution. ANALYSIS: As a **theory of change**, it mis-specified where and when revolution would mature. ANALYSIS: As a **political project**, it is weakest: transitional states entrenched rather than withered, and the model supplies no mechanism subordinating party to class.

What the tradition has already repaired. ANALYSIS: Gramsci relocates ideology into civil society as an achievement that can be lost; Poulantzas replaces the instrumental state with relative autonomy - refinement rather than refutation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Marxism is a fully formed political ideology whose **diagnostic power exceeds its institutional prescription**: the analysis of exploitation and ideological reproduction survives, while the transition requires safeguards its own theory of the state discouraged it from building. CAUTION: Whether those safeguards can be supplied without abandoning the theory remains contested.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem's own words - "as a Political Ideology" - are a scoring instruction. Placing Marxism on the six-component test and in both senses of the word does the first half; grading the four aspects does the second.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: double placement three lines; six components three; grading five; repairs two; verdict two.

- **Structure:** both senses of ideology -> six-component placement -> grade four aspects -> the tradition's own repairs -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** analytical and critical senses; method, critique, theory of change, political project.
- **Evidence:** the fetters mechanism; the formally free contract; the four dimensions of alienation; hegemony and relative autonomy.
- **Distinction:** diagnostic power against institutional prescription.
- **Criticism:** the open question about whether safeguards are compatible with the theory, stated as contested.

Six original questions in the paper's own idiom - two at 10 marks, two at 15 and two at 20 - each solved to the same standard as the previous-year parts above. None reproduces an owned stem; each targets a route the corpus has tested indirectly or is likely to test again.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: "Nationalisation is not socialisation." Comment.

Independent model answer

Claim. ANALYSIS: The statement is correct, and it identifies the single most useful control in the socialist family.

The distinction. FACT: **Nationalisation** transfers ownership of productive assets to the organs of the state.

Socialisation requires that productive property and economic power be subject to **social control** - control exercised by society through democratic and participatory institutions.

Why transfer of title is insufficient. ANALYSIS: Ownership answers the question *who holds the asset*; socialism's question is *who decides* about investment, production, pace and purpose. A ministry-run monopoly may answer the first without altering the second, in which case the worker exchanges a private superior for an official one and the standing subjection remains.

The named objection this meets. FACT: State ownership can become ownership by officials - the bureaucratic-domination objection. The reply is that socialism requires democratic control, workplace participation and accountability, and that nationalisation alone is not socialisation.

Evidence from the family. FACT: **Guild socialism** is the cleanest illustration, since it opposes private capitalism **and** bureaucratic statism simultaneously; **market socialism** makes the same point from the other side, separating markets from capitalist ownership.

Qualification. CAUTION: The test is sharp at the extremes and indeterminate in the middle range, and it leaves open how democratic control over investment is reconciled with the technical demands of large-scale coordination.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Nationalisation is at most an instrument of socialisation and is never identical with it; the philosophical question is control, not title.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "Comment" stem on a slogan requires the slogan to be converted into a criterion. The *who decides* test does that in one line and generates both the objection and the illustrations.

- **Structure:** claim -> definitions -> why title is insufficient -> the objection it meets -> family illustrations -> qualification -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** social control, democratic participation, accountability.
- **Evidence:** guild socialism and market socialism as the two-sided demonstration.
- **Distinction:** who holds against who decides.
- **Criticism:** the indeterminacy of the test in the middle range, conceded rather than concealed.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between exploitation and alienation in Marx. Why does the distinction matter?

Independent model answer

The distinction. FACT: **Exploitation** concerns the appropriation of what is produced: labour-power is bought under a formally free contract, the value produced during the working day can exceed the value represented by wages, and the remainder is appropriated as surplus value. **Alienation** concerns dispossession of the activity and its meaning: estrangement from the product, from the act of labour, from species-being and from other persons.

The test that separates them. ANALYSIS: Ask what would remove each. Exploitation is removed by changing who appropriates the surplus. Alienation is removed only by changing who controls the labour process and for what purpose. Neither operation entails the other.

Why it matters - three consequences. FACT: First, it explains why higher wages leave alienation untouched, since remuneration is not control. Second, it explains why a cooperative that abolishes surplus appropriation may still organise work in an estranging way. Third, it explains why redistribution can reduce inequality while leaving both untouched, since transfers alter neither appropriation nor control.

The exam consequence. ANALYSIS: The paper has asked about each separately, and an answer that merges them cannot handle either stem, because the four dimensions belong to one concept and the five-step mechanism to the other.

Qualification. CAUTION: The two are nevertheless connected in Marx's own account, since the separation of the worker from the means of production is the common condition of both - so they are distinct concepts with a shared origin rather than unrelated ones.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "distinguish and say why it matters" stem needs a working test rather than two definitions. The removal test supplies it and generates the three consequences directly.

- **Structure:** distinction -> the removal test -> three consequences -> exam consequence -> shared-origin qualification.
- **Doctrine:** surplus value; the four dimensions of estranged labour.
- **Evidence:** the cooperative case, which isolates control from appropriation.
- **Distinction:** appropriation against control.
- **Criticism:** the shared condition, which prevents the distinction from becoming a separation.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: "The anarchist and the Marxist agree about domination and disagree about the state." Critically examine.

Independent model answer

Thesis. ANALYSIS: The statement is accurate about the disagreement and misleading about the agreement, and separating those two claims is the whole answer.

Where they genuinely agree. FACT: Both hold that existing society is structured by domination rather than by mere inequality; both reject the view that formal legal freedom is sufficient; and both project an end-state in which the state as an instrument of class domination has ceased to be necessary.

Where the agreement is thinner than it looks. ANALYSIS: They do not agree about **what domination is**. Anarchism identifies authority and hierarchy as the primary domination, so the state is the paradigm case. Marxism identifies the class relation rooted in production, so the state is an effect whose abolition without transformation of property would leave capitalist power intact. The shared vocabulary conceals a difference in the explanandum.

The disagreement about the state. FACT: Anarchism would abolish or supersede the state **without transitional sovereignty**, organising through federation, autonomy and voluntary association. Marxism has the working class exercise **transitional political power** through class organisation. FACT: Bakunin predicts that such a revolutionary state may create a **new ruling stratum**; Marxists reply that organised class power is required to defeat entrenched property and coercion, and that premature abolition is disarmament.

Why the exchange is unresolved. ANALYSIS: Each side identifies a real danger created by the other's remedy. Retaining organisation concentrates power without a reliable mechanism of recall - the substitutionism problem. Abolishing it disperses power unaccountably, leaving expertise, status and economic strength ungoverned - the hidden-authority problem.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The agreement is about the **fact** of domination and not about its **mechanism**; the disagreement about the state follows from that deeper difference rather than standing beside it. CAUTION: Neither side has supplied an institutional answer to the danger the other names.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critically examine" a proposition means testing both halves. The mark-bearing move is showing that the agreement is shallower than stated, which explains why the disagreement is not merely tactical.

- **Structure:** thesis -> genuine agreement -> why it is thinner -> the disagreement -> why unresolved -> verdict.

- **Doctrine:** primary domination; transitional sovereignty; federation against class organisation.
- **Evidence:** Bakunin's prediction and the Marxist reply, presented as an unresolved exchange.
- **Distinction:** agreement about the fact against disagreement about the mechanism.
- **Criticism:** the symmetrical residuals - substitutionism and hidden authority - named as the reason no verdict is available.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Examine whether the concept of ideology can be applied to Marxism itself.

Independent model answer

Thesis. ANALYSIS: It can, on both senses of the word, and the interesting question is what follows in the second case.

The analytical sense. FACT: Marxism satisfies the six-component test in full: it describes persons as social producers formed within class relations, diagnoses domination in the mode of production, evaluates through non-domination and non-alienated self-development, states a view of property, authority and the state, prescribes class struggle and revolutionary transition, and projects a classless order. On this sense the application is uncontroversial.

The critical sense. FACT: Here ideology is a socially rooted framework in which historically specific relations appear natural, universal or inevitable. **ANALYSIS:** Applying it to Marxism is the reflexivity problem: if all thought is socially rooted, the theory of ideology is itself produced under determinate social conditions and cannot claim a view from nowhere.

The strongest reply. ANALYSIS: Marxism does not claim an outside. It claims that **structural position** generates differential experience, so that those whose labour is appropriated encounter the gap between the framework's promises and their conditions. Gramsci develops this as **contradictory consciousness** - an inherited common sense coexisting with a "good sense" derived from practical experience - which explains how critique becomes possible without exemption from ideology.

Why the reply is incomplete. CAUTION: Friction explains the **possibility** of critique without establishing its **correctness**, and neither Marx nor Gramsci supplies an independent test distinguishing hegemonic consensus from ordinary well-founded agreement. Althusser's route makes the difficulty sharper still, since if subjects are constituted by ideological apparatuses, the theorist is a constituted subject too.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Marxism is an ideology in the analytical sense without embarrassment, and is subject to the critical concept without self-refutation - but only at the cost of conceding that its own claims must be defended by argument rather than by an unavailable epistemic privilege.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem is a reflexivity question, and the temptation is either to deny the application or to accept it as fatal. The correct route is to accept it and specify the cost.

- **Structure:** thesis -> analytical sense -> critical sense -> the strongest reply -> why it is incomplete -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the six components; ideology as naturalisation; contradictory consciousness.
- **Evidence:** the structural-position argument; Althusser's constituted subject as the sharper form of the problem.
- **Distinction:** possibility of critique against validation of critique.
- **Criticism:** the missing independent test, conceded as the price of avoiding self-refutation.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Every ideology in this clause is stronger as a diagnosis than as a remedy." Discuss with reference to anarchism, Marxism and socialism.

Independent model answer

Provisional thesis. ANALYSIS: The proposition is true of all three, but for three different reasons, and the value of the claim lies entirely in specifying which residual defeats which remedy.

Anarchism. FACT: The diagnosis is powerful: the state demands obedience because a command is legally authoritative rather than because it is right, and such a standing right subordinates one person's judgment to another's

institutional will; Bakunin adds that concentrated power deforms both ruler and ruled. ANALYSIS: The remedy is weaker. Three objections can be relocated - the security dilemma by federated defence and restorative institutions, the scale objection by distinguishing centralised domination from coordination, and the anthropological objection because anarchists need only deny that hierarchy is the unique or best remedy. ANALYSIS: The fourth cannot: expertise, informal status and economic power return after the state disappears, and the tradition's own defenders concede that domination inside voluntary associations must be scrutinised.

Marxism. FACT: The diagnosis is the most systematic of the three: exploitation arises through a formally free contract because workers lack independent access to the means of production and competition compels accumulation; alienation operates across product, activity, species-being and other persons; ideology naturalises historically specific relations; and the fetters mechanism explains why orders change. ANALYSIS: The remedy is the weakest of the three, because transitional states entrenched rather than withered, and the most developed transitional model contains no mechanism subordinating party to class - the substitutionism residual.

Socialism. FACT: The diagnosis holds that productive capacities are socially inherited and cooperatively exercised, that private control of indispensable assets gives some persons power over others' life-chances, and that market outcomes do not track need, desert or equal freedom. ANALYSIS: The remedy is indeterminate rather than defeated: social control may be public, cooperative, guild, worker or mixed, and nationalisation is not automatically socialisation, so the family owes an account of accountable design that it has not settled.

The common structure. ANALYSIS: In each case the remedy fails at the same point - it removes one form of standing power without demonstrating that it will not generate another. That is why "hidden authority", "substitutionism" and "bureaucratic domination" are three names for one problem.

Qualification. CAUTION: The proposition should not be read as a dismissal. FACT: Every ideology contains a regulative picture of justified order, and feasibility must **constrain** normativity rather than replace it; an incomplete institutional answer is not an argument for the arrangements the diagnosis condemns.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The statement is accurate and asymmetric: the three diagnoses survive their strongest objections, the three remedies do not, and the honest conclusion is that the clause's unfinished business is the design of accountable power rather than the choice among its three critiques.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a proposition covering all three families invites a generic answer. The mark-bearing move is refusing the generic verdict by naming a **different** residual for each family and then showing that the three residuals share a structure.

- **Structure:** thesis -> anarchism -> Marxism -> socialism -> the common structure -> qualification -> asymmetric verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the burden of justification; exploitation, alienation and the fetters mechanism; social control against nationalisation.
- **Evidence:** hidden authority, substitutionism and bureaucratic domination as the three named residuals.
- **Distinction:** defeated remedy against indeterminate remedy.
- **Criticism:** the refusal to let feasibility replace normativity, which prevents the answer from collapsing into scepticism.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Assess the claim that neo-Marxism refines rather than refutes classical Marxism.

Independent model answer

Provisional thesis. ANALYSIS: The claim is defensible for three of the four major revisions and strained for the fourth, and the assessment turns on what "refinement" is taken to preserve.

What is being revised. FACT: Four classical claims are at issue: that revolution matures where capitalism is most advanced and consciousness develops from workers' own conditions; that ruling ideas are the ideas of the ruling class and ideology is a reflex of the base; that the state is an instrument of the ruling class; and that consciousness is determined by social being.

Lenin - refinement. FACT: Imperialism converts capitalism into a global system whose contradictions are unevenly distributed, so the chain breaks at its **weakest link**; and since spontaneous struggle yields only trade-union consciousness, a vanguard party under **democratic centralism** must supply political consciousness. ANALYSIS: The materialist mechanism is retained; what changes is the location and agency of transformation. ANALYSIS: The cost is the **substitutionism** residual, which the model cannot answer.

Gramsci - refinement. FACT: Hegemony makes ideological leadership an achievement won and lost in **civil society**, staffed by organic intellectuals, requiring a **war of position** before any war of manoeuvre. ANALYSIS: Class relations remain the ultimate site of conflict; causal weight moves to the superstructure without leaving it.

Miliband and Poulantzas - refinement, with a boundary. FACT: Miliband's instrumentalism identifies social composition, structural leverage and positional interest; Poulantzas replies that capital's internal fractions require a state with **relative autonomy** able to act against particular capitalists and to appear to represent "the people". ANALYSIS: The refinement is genuine, but it has an internal limit: stretched far enough, relative autonomy becomes the pluralist state under another name, and the analysis stops being Marxist.

Althusser - the strained case. FACT: Subjects are **produced** by ideological apparatuses through interpellation, and ideology is a material practice rather than a false picture. ANALYSIS: This displaces the humanist categories of alienation and species-being altogether, which is not obviously a refinement of a doctrine in which those categories carried the normative charge. CAUTION: Whether structural anti-humanism continues the same project or replaces it is genuinely contested.

The controlling formula. ANALYSIS: Neo-Marxism does not abandon the materialist mechanism; it **relocates causal weight into the superstructure** - into party, culture, state form and subject-formation - while retaining the claim that class relations are the ultimate site of conflict. ANALYSIS: The best synthesis needs both a structural explanation of power and an account of the agents whose self-emancipation could transform it.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Neo-Marxism refines classical Marxism where it relocates causal weight while preserving the class mechanism, and approaches refutation only where it removes the normative categories that made emancipation intelligible - so the claim holds for Lenin, Gramsci and the state debate, and holds only conditionally for Althusser.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: an "assess the claim" stem is scored on discrimination. Treating all four revisions alike produces a generic endorsement; separating the three refinements from the strained case produces a judgment.

- **Structure:** thesis -> the four claims revised -> Lenin -> Gramsci -> the state debate with its boundary -> Althusser as the strained case -> controlling formula -> discriminating verdict.
- **Doctrine:** weakest link, vanguard, hegemony, war of position, relative autonomy, interpellation.
- **Evidence:** Miliband 1969 and Poulantzas 1973, cited by title and year; the remaining figures by position only.
- **Distinction:** relocation of causal weight against removal of normative categories.
- **Criticism:** the internal limit of relative autonomy and the contested status of anti-humanism, both stated as boundaries rather than resolved.